Week 12

JOURNEY

JOURNEY: ADVOCATES® · LEADER HANDOUT · UNIT 3 · LESSON 4

Designer

BIG IDEA

Science doesn't contradict faith: fine-tuning, DNA and design all give evidence for God. As the creation and evolution conversation comes alive, help eager students speak in truth and love, and give unsure students room to ask for more.

Key points from the Leader Video

1. Recap: science is a foundation for understanding our world, not a contradiction of faith, and fine-tuning, DNA and design each point to God.
2. Keep two kinds of students in mind this week. Design is where the conversation between creation and evolution really comes alive.
3. Some students will be fired up to argue with teachers who likely know more than they do. Champion them, but coach them to speak in truth and love.
4. Challenging teachers and classmates is okay when done with appropriate respect, especially toward teachers, and in the right kinds of conversations.
5. Other students are still unsure. Take inventory with them plainly: was this enough evidence, do they need more, and what questions remain?
6. The goal is a deep conviction about what they believe and why, shared relationally with love and humility. Help eager students be patient; there's more to learn.

FOR YOU

Before club: think it through yourself.

1. When I'm eager to win an argument, does my tone still show truth and love?
2. Which unsure student could I take inventory with one-on-one this week?
3. How well can I explain why I believe, not just what I believe?

ASK YOUR GROUP

In small group: questions to ask your students.

1. Of fine-tuning, DNA and design, which evidence for God seems strongest to you, and why?
2. What would you still need to see or hear to feel more sure about any of this?
3. If a teacher disagreed with you about creation, how could you respond with respect?
4. What's the difference between winning an argument and having a good conversation?
5. What questions or clarifications would help you most right now?

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WEEK 12 · LEADER VIDEO

The full transcript

The talk from this week's Leader Video, lightly edited for reading. Times point back to that moment in the video.

Wrapping up science

0:05 So we've almost made it through science. We've discovered that science is really a foundation for understanding our world, and that it does not contradict our faith. Well, that's good news. We've also taken a look at three really good pieces of evidence that help us see that God is actually there — that we have evidence for God. We looked at the idea of fine-tuning, we looked at the idea of DNA, and we looked at the idea of design. All of these point to God in some way, shape, or form through the use of science.

The eager student

0:44 Now, I want you to keep in mind two kinds of students this week. The first kind is the student who has all this information and is super fired up, ready to go with the best arguments they have to their teacher — who probably knows more than they do about all these things — especially this week with the idea of design, because this is where the conversation between creation and evolution starts to really come alive.

1:10 It might seem like this is a good idea for them to jump off and start all these arguments and try to win people to Christ. They might try it, and you want to champion that, but at the same time make sure that they do so in truth and love. If they're going to have these conversations, you don't want to tell them not to. It's okay that they can challenge their teachers, and it's okay to challenge their students, but to do so with love, and to do so with the appropriate amount of respect — especially for teachers — as well as engaging in the right kinds of conversations.

The student still unsure

1:46 Now, the other type of student is maybe the one who really is still not sure, or the one who wasn't sure before entering into this conversation. Now would be a really good time to just take a step back and take inventory with that student, and ask them the plain question. Was this enough evidence? Do you need more? What further questions do you have? What clarifications do you need?

Why we do this study

2:12 Now remember the reason why we're doing this study. It's so that our students can have a deep conviction for themselves about what they believe and why they believe it, and also be able to communicate that in love and humility, and do so relationally. So while it might be really exciting to have some eager students ready to get started and to get engaged in conversation, help them be patient, because there is so much more to learn.